

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Data analyst and quantitative finance professional with ~7 years building data-driven analytics for institutional finance. CFA charterholder and dual MSc with hands-on Python, SQL, VBA and Excel application development; integrates large data sets across relational stores (PostgreSQL; Oracle-analogous environments) to surface credit and market insights. Has shipped production analytics pipelines, data-driven research reports and quantitative visualizations for global asset managers, pensions and insurers.

CORE SKILLS

Python (pandas, NumPy, SciPy) • SQL & Relational Databases (PostgreSQL; Oracle-analogous environments) • VBA & Advanced Excel Application Development • Analytics Pipeline Development (Python-based ETL and workflow automation) • Large Data Set Integration & Mining • Data Visualization (Plotly, matplotlib) • Credit, Fixed Income & Capital Markets Knowledge • Quantitative Research & Financial Modelling • Git / Version Control; CI-CD Pipelines

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services | Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Analytics Pipeline & Data Infrastructure

- Re-engineered manual Excel and spreadsheet workflows into scalable, auditable Python analytics pipelines with embedded logging, validation and version control.
- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash-flow projection engine integrating data from portfolio, instrument and market-data sources, supporting base, stress and reverse-stress scenarios.
- Architected configurable time-bucketed analytics (T+1 through multi-year) connecting portfolio, instrument and market-data sets to surface funding and liquidity insights for institutional clients.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating code generation, validation scaffolding and documentation - reducing development cycle time by an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.

Data-Driven Research & Reporting

- Produced data-driven analytical summaries and presentations for senior client stakeholders covering interest-rate exposure, scenario impacts and balance-sheet sensitivities across multi-asset portfolios.
- Held delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity and ALM outputs delivered to institutional client portfolios ranging \$5-25bn per engagement; independently reviewed curve construction, spread calibration and cross-asset interactions prior to release.
- Validated derivatives pricing outputs (rates, FX, inflation) and cross-checked sensitivity consistency at portfolio-level aggregates feeding downstream research and risk processes.

Cross-Functional Collaboration & Product Implementation

- Collaborated with product owners, modelling specialists and client investment teams on implementation of new analytics products and process improvements; translated quantitative findings into decision-ready narratives for Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders.
- Served as primary escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, reconciling methodology questions across technical and business functions.

Client Service Specialist - PFaroe Platform | Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers and consulting firms migrating to an enterprise analytics platform; scoped client requirements into structured development requests for Product Owners.
- Contributed to the successful migration of all assigned client accounts from a legacy Calypso environment to the PFaroe PM platform, validating model and data outputs post-deployment.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant - IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation | Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 technology-transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning accounting standards with data, system and financial-reporting architecture.
- Coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT and program-management teams on milestone delivery, governance documentation and regulatory-readiness materials.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk | Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators integrating large market and macro data sets to assess interest-rate, inflation and currency risk under base and stressed environments.
- Delivered ALM studies and liability-driven investment (LDI) analyses for Canadian and international pension funds; modelled actuarial liabilities alongside all major investment-product types and economic variables.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability portfolio optimization based on VaR and CVaR, with risk decomposition and attribution analysis to test the robustness of allocation recommendations.
- Presented data-driven findings - including quantitative scenario reports and sensitivity visualizations - to investment committees and senior stakeholders at pension-fund clients.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016